Jazz 2024-25: shot quality and shot-making, one page

For: coaching, scouting, performance. Data: public shot-chart data, 2024-25 regular season. Model: expected points per shot from location and shot type; no defender tracking. Method and caveats in the repo README.

Bottom line

1. **We took low-value shots**, 27th of 30 in expected points per shot (1.066 vs a league range of 1.04-1.12). The driver is a low rim rate.

2. **Our shooting was exactly as good as the shots deserved** (0.0 points per 100 shots over expected, 18th), but unevenly: good inside and in the corners, poor on above-the-break threes and mid-range.

3. **The shots we allowed were fine; how they were made was not.** Opponent shot quality ranked 9th best, yet opponents shot **+4.6 points per 100 above expectation, 29th of 30** (about 350 points, or 4 per game). It was concentrated at the rim, non-restricted paint and mid-range.

Shot mix: where the value gap comes from

Zone	Jazz share of attempts	League share	Opponents' shots vs Jazz
Rim	**23.2%**	27.9%	24.2%
Paint (non-restricted)	24.8%	20.3%	23.1%
Mid-range	7.2%	9.8%	8.1%
Corner 3	12.8%	10.8%	10.3%
Above-break 3	32.0%	31.2%	34.3%

About 4.5 points of attempt share sit in non-restricted-paint twos instead of at the rim, and those are worth far less (0.89 vs 1.33 points per shot league-wide).

Shot-making by zone (points over expected per 100 shots)

Zone	Jazz	Jazz opponents
Rim	+5.4	**+8.0**
Paint (non-restricted)	+5.1	**+10.5**
Mid-range	**-8.2**	**+8.3**
Corner 3	+3.1	+1.9
Above-break 3	**-7.3** (about 170 points on 2,321 attempts)	-2.1

What to trust

- **Team-level year-to-year persistence** (30 teams, three season pairs): shot quality allowed r = 0.80, shot quality taken 0.59, shot-making 0.51, **shot-making allowed 0.41**. The allowed figure is partly real (contest quality and rim deterrence are not in this data) and partly luck. I would treat it as a lead for film and tracking review, not a verdict.

- **Individual shot-making is noisy.** Estimates below are shrunk toward the league mean; the bar is a 90% interval. Only four players' intervals exclude zero.

Player (shots)	Points over expected / 100 (90% interval)
Brice Sensabaugh (599)	**+9.1** (+2.1, +16.1)
Collin Sexton (867)	**+6.7** (+1.1, +12.3)
John Collins (531)	+4.3 (-2.2, +10.9)
Kyle Filipowski (518)	+4.1 (-2.9, +11.0)
Johnny Juzang (475)	+1.8 (-5.8, +9.4)
Walker Kessler (419)	+1.5 (-4.8, +7.9)
Jordan Clarkson (493)	+0.5 (-6.7, +7.6)
Svi Mykhailiuk (302)	-2.4 (-11.0, +6.2)

Player (shots)	Points over expected / 100 (90% interval)
Keyonte George (919)	-3.4 (-9.3, +2.5)
Lauri Markkanen (700)	-4.5 (-11.0, +2.0)
Isaiah Collier (555)	**-7.4** (-13.9, -0.8)
Cody Williams (257)	**-13.0** (-21.7, -4.2), smallest sample; raw figure was -26 before shrinkage

Injuries, role and minutes are not in the data; a low rating on few shots mostly means "unlucky or unmeasured", not "poor shooter".

What I would do next

1. Pull contest/closest-defender data for opponent rim and paint attempts to test whether the +8 to +10 is defence or luck.

2. Size the prize for closing the 4.7-point rim-share gap: about 340 shots at roughly 0.40 expected points each (Jazz rim 1.28 vs non-restricted paint 0.88) is about 135 points a season. That is an upper bound, since not every paint shot can become a rim attempt.

3. Re-run with 2025-26 data once available; the pipeline scores new files with `scripts/score_shots.py`.



